with rockets on 14 January, effectively closing the station from 14 to 17 January 1982. On 16 January, the mujahideen active in Kandahar city fled from a Soviet onslaught, retiring to the rural parts of Kandahar and Panjawai districts. They did not return to the town till the end of January. Some mujahideen had approached the locals for donations, but in contrast to their actions in the past, the locals told the mujahideen that they were still grieving the loss of family and property and so could not contribute monetary help. General Abdul Qadir, acting defence minister of Afghanistan, synchronised his visit to Kandahar city with the Russian action against the mujahideen, which indicated that the Soviets had the approval of the defence ministry. In February, the Soviet offensives in Kandahar, Herat, Lashkar Gah and other regions of southern Afghanistan caused the leaders of the mujahideen to flee to Pakistan for consultations, while the rank and file were told to assemble in Zhanjawat in Kandahar, where they dug trenches for their safety.

Obviously the rebels were neither capable nor prepared to face Soviet action and the heavy Soviet blow left them unable to react. A R&AW dispatch said that residents of Kandahar had seen reports about the misery of Afghans in Pakistan refugee camps, where they did not even have the minimum necessities of life.

The Afghanistan government continued to mobilise the support of tribal chieftains and the clergy by various incentives, monetary and otherwise. Dr Najibullah, the chief of the Afghan security agencies, and Suleiman Laiq, the minister in charge of tribes, visited important tribal areas. The mullahs were won over by material goods, including the repairs and renovations of old mosques and the construction of new ones. In January